

4 September 2026

Dear Editor,

We are pleased to resubmit our revised manuscript, “Does Wind Disrupt Overwintering Monarch Butterfly Clusters? An Observational Study of Western Monarchs,” for consideration in the *Insects* Special Issue “Advances in Monarch Butterfly Biology, Conservation, and Management: From Local to Continental.”

The revised manuscript is shorter, limits its claims to the monitored conditions, corrects the model-comparison workflow, and makes the processed data and analytical materials public. We believe its empirical monitoring, methodological transparency, and conservation relevance fit the scope of the special issue. We are grateful to the reviewers for their careful comments, which substantially improved the manuscript.

The processed data, model formulas, analysis code, model outputs, classification protocol, and classification software are publicly available on GitHub. A USGS ScienceBase release of the underlying photographs, metadata, classifications, wind measurements, and reviewed study temperature values is in preparation and will be publicly available before publication.

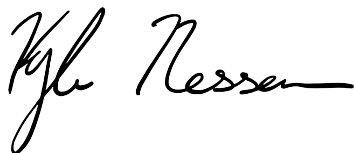
Two authors are affiliated with the U.S. Geological Survey. The required USGS approval process has been initiated, and the ScienceBase release described above is being prepared. We expect these parallel steps to be completed during the journal’s review and production process. Both must be complete before final publication. We therefore ask that editorial review and production proceed as usual, with final online publication held until the corresponding author confirms completion. Please confirm that this publication hold has been recorded.

The resubmission includes a clean LaTeX source archive and compiled PDF, a comparison PDF showing additions and deletions from the original submission, and a point-by-point response to the Academic Editor and reviewers. The clean files provide the authoritative revised manuscript, while the comparison PDF is intended as a review aid.

We confirm that neither the manuscript nor any parts of its content are currently under consideration for publication with or published in another journal. All authors have approved the manuscript and agree with its submission to *Insects*.

Thank you for considering our work. We look forward to your response.

Sincerely,

A handwritten signature in black ink, reading "Kyle Nessen". The signature is fluid and cursive, with the first name "Kyle" and last name "Nessen" clearly distinguishable.

Kyle Nessen

Corresponding author

On behalf of the co-authors Peter C. Ibsen, Jay E. Diffendorfer, and Francis X. Villablanca

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